Functional Newton Methods for Operator Learning

Thiago R. Ramos

Joint work with Alek Fröhlich, Daniel Perazzo, and Massimiliano Pontil

Universidade Federal de São Carlos – UFSCar

November 05, 2026



Learn One Operator, Answer Many Questions



$$(\mathcal{E}f)(x) = \mathbb{E}\big[f(Y) \mid X = x\big]$$

What we do not know

$P_{X,Y}$, the joint distribution

What we observe

$\mathcal{D}_n = \{(X_i, Y_i)\}_{i=1}^n$

Main question: How can we learn $\mathcal{E}$ from the sample?

Supervised Learning

First, let us learn one conditional expectation.

Supervised Learning in Three Steps

1. OBSERVE

(X_i, Y_i)

input–output pairs

$\rightarrow$

2. LEARN

$g : \mathcal{X} \to \mathcal{Y}$

a prediction rule

$\rightarrow$

3. PREDICT

$x \mapsto g(x)$

an output close to y

The pairs are independent draws from an unknown distribution:

$$\mathcal{D}_n = \{(X_i, Y_i)\}_{i=1}^n, \qquad (X_i, Y_i) \overset{\text{i.i.d.}}{\sim} P_{X,Y}.$$

We use examples to learn a rule that predicts new outputs.

A Loss Function Defines "Close"

One prediction produces one error:

$$\text{observed } Y \quad \longleftrightarrow \quad \text{predicted } g(X) \quad \xrightarrow{\ell} \quad \text{loss.}$$

Squared loss

$$\ell(y, \widehat{y}) = (y - \widehat{y})^2$$

Penalizes large errors more strongly.

Absolute loss

$$\ell(y, \widehat{y}) = |y - \widehat{y}|$$

Grows linearly with the error.

Population risk is simply the average loss: $R(g) = \mathbb{E}[\ell(Y, g(X))]$.

The Loss Determines What We Learn

For each x, choose the prediction a that minimizes the conditional loss:

$$g^\star(x) \in \operatorname*{argmin}_a \mathbb{E}[\ell(Y, a) \mid X = x].$$

Squared loss $(Y - a)^2$

derivative equals zero at

$$g^\star(x) = \mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x]$$

Target: conditional mean

Absolute loss $|Y - a|$

subgradient contains zero at

$$g^\star(x) \in \text{Median}(Y \mid X = x)$$

Target: conditional median

Changing the loss changes the conditional quantity we learn.

From Now On: Squared Loss

OBJECTIVE

$$\min_{g} \mathbb{E}[(Y - g(X))^2]$$

Find the function with the smallest average squared error.

$\Longrightarrow$

POPULATION SOLUTION

$$g^\star(x) = \mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x]$$

The best predictor is the conditional mean.

This conditional mean will be our bridge to operator learning.

Different Models, Same Target

All these models try to approximate $g^\star(x) = \mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x]$.

Linear regression

Affine relationships

Kernel methods

Similarities between observations

Decision trees

Partitions of the input space

Neural networks

Flexible nonlinear representations

Random forests

Averages of randomized trees

Gradient boosting

Small corrections learned sequentially

Gradient Boosting

Next, we move from parameters to functions.

Boosting Builds the Model Step by Step

START

$g_0(x)$

initial prediction

$+$

CORRECTION m

$\eta\, h_m(x)$

a small tree

$+ \cdots$

FINAL MODEL

$g_M(x)$

sum of corrections

$$\boxed{g_M(x) = g_0(x) + \eta \sum_{m=1}^{M} h_m(x)} \qquad \approx \qquad \mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x].$$

Simple learners

Each h_m can be a shallow decision tree.

Learning rate

η controls how much each correction changes the model.

Gradient Descent: Follow the Downhill Direction

1. Current point

θ_t

Evaluate the gradient.

$\rightarrow$

2. Direction

$-\nabla f(\theta_t)$

Move downhill.

$\rightarrow$

3. New point

θ_{t+1}

Lower the objective.

Goal

$$\min_{\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p} f(\theta)$$

Update

$$\boxed{\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t - \eta \nabla f(\theta_t)}$$

The gradient points uphill, so its negative points downhill.

Each Step Adds a Correction

Name the descent direction

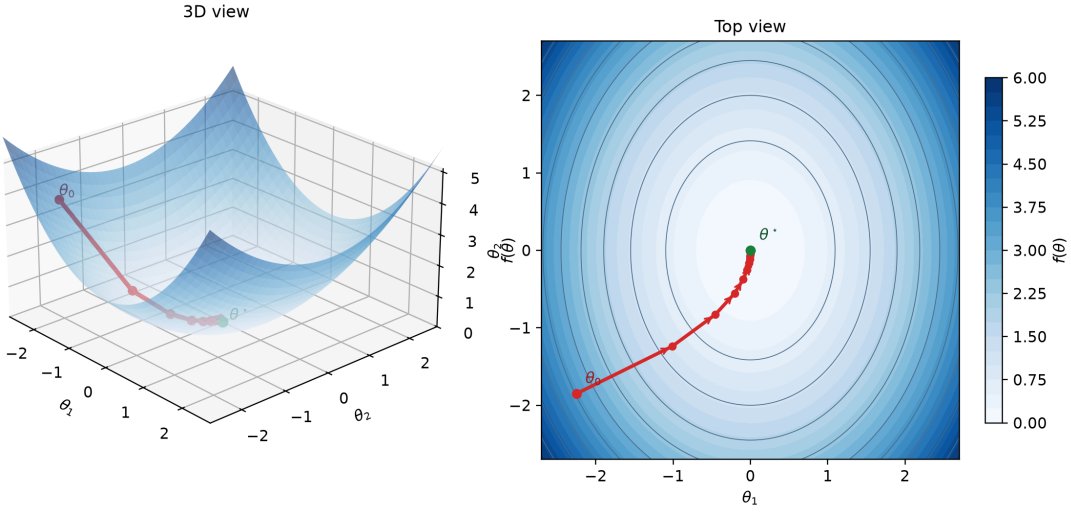
$$h_t = -\nabla f(\theta_t).$$

CURRENT θ_t $+$ **CORRECTION** ηh_t $=$ **NEXT** θ_{t+1}

With a suitable step size, $f(\theta_{t+1}) \leq f(\theta_t)$.

This additive form is the connection to gradient boosting.

Gradient Descent on a Quadratic Landscape



Gradient Descent and Boosting Share the Same Pattern

GRADIENT DESCENT

$$\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t + \eta h_t$$

$$\Downarrow \qquad \theta_T = \theta_0 + \eta \sum_{t=0}^{T-1} h_t$$

corrections are vectors h_t

GRADIENT BOOSTING

$$g_m = g_{m-1} + \eta h_m$$

$$\Downarrow \qquad g_M = g_0 + \eta \sum_{m=1}^{M} h_m$$

corrections are functions h_m

initial solution $+$ sequence of corrections

The algebra is the same; only the type of object changes.

Gradient Boosting Optimizes a Whole Function

Ordinary gradient descent

Variable: vector $\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p$

Objective: number $f(\theta)$

$$\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t - \eta \nabla f(\theta_t)$$

Gradient boosting

Variable: function $g \in \mathcal{H}$

Objective: risk $\mathcal{R}(g)$

$$g_{t+1} = g_t - \eta \nabla \mathcal{R}(g_t)$$

Gradient boosting is gradient descent in function space.

Three Ingredients Move Optimization to Function Space

1. SEARCH SPACE

Where does the variable live?

$$g \in \mathcal{H}$$

2. GEOMETRY

How do we measure angles?

$$\langle g, h \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}$$

3. GRADIENT

Which direction is uphill?

$$\nabla \mathcal{R}(g)$$

Vectors		**Functions**
$\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p$	$\longrightarrow$	$g \in \mathcal{H}$
$u^\top v$	$\longrightarrow$	$\langle g, h \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}$
$\nabla f(\theta)$	$\longrightarrow$	$\nabla \mathcal{R}(g)$

Squared-Loss Regression Lives in $L^2(P_X)$

FUNCTION SPACE

$$\mathcal{H} = L^2(P_X)$$

Functions with finite average squared magnitude:

$$\mathbb{E}[g(X)^2] < \infty.$$

GEOMETRY

$$\langle g, h \rangle_{\mathcal{H}} = \mathbb{E}[g(X)h(X)]$$

and therefore

$$\|g\|_{\mathcal{H}}^2 = \mathbb{E}[g(X)^2].$$

Our optimization variable is now a function: $\min_{g \in \mathcal{H}} \mathcal{R}(g)$.

$$\mathcal{R}(g) = \mathbb{E}[(Y - g(X))^2].$$

A Functional Derivative Asks: "What If We Perturb g?"

$$g \quad \longrightarrow \quad g + \varepsilon h$$

perturb g in direction h

Directional change

$$D\mathcal{F}(g)[h] = \lim_{\varepsilon \to 0} \frac{\mathcal{F}(g + \varepsilon h) - \mathcal{F}(g)}{\varepsilon}$$

This is a number for each direction h.

Functional gradient

$$D\mathcal{F}(g)[h] = \langle h, \nabla \mathcal{F}(g) \rangle_{\mathcal{H}}$$

Riesz represents all directional changes by one gradient function.

It is the usual derivative idea, but the variable is a function.

The Squared-Loss Gradient Appears in Three Lines

1. RISK

$$\mathcal{R}(g) = \mathbb{E}[(Y - g(X))^2]$$

Start with squared loss.

2. DIFFERENTIATE

$$D\mathcal{R}(g)[h] = 2\mathbb{E}[(g(X) - Y)h(X)]$$

Perturb in direction h.

3. CONDITION ON X

$$D\mathcal{R}(g)[h] = \langle 2\mathbb{E}[g(X) - Y \mid X], h \rangle$$

Use the tower property.

The function inside the inner product is the functional gradient.

The Negative Gradient Is a Conditional Residual

FUNCTIONAL GRADIENT

$$\nabla \mathcal{R}(g)(x) = 2\,\mathbb{E}[g(X) - Y \mid X = x]$$



DESCENT DIRECTION

$$-\nabla \mathcal{R}(g)(x) \propto \mathbb{E}[Y - g(X) \mid X = x]$$

expected residual at input x

$$g_{t+1}(x) = g_t(x) + 2\eta\,\mathbb{E}[Y - g_t(X) \mid X = x].$$

One Boosting Iteration Is an Ordinary Regression

1. RESIDUALS

$$r_i^{(t)} = Y_i - g_t(X_i)$$

compute what the model misses

→

2. FIT A TREE

$$(X_i, r_i^{(t)})$$

estimate the conditional residual

→

3. UPDATE

$$g_{t+1} = g_t + \eta h_t$$

add the fitted correction

$h_t(x)$ approximates $\mathbb{E}[Y - g_t(X) \mid X = x]$.

The abstract functional step becomes a familiar supervised-learning problem.

The Translation from Vectors to Functions

	Gradient descent	**Gradient boosting**
Variable	$\theta \in \mathbb{R}^p$	$g \in L^2(P_X)$
Objective	$f(\theta)$	$\mathcal{R}(g) = \mathbb{E}[(Y - g(X))^2]$
Direction	$-\nabla f(\theta_t)$	conditional residual
Approximation	exact vector	fitted tree h_t
Update	$\theta_{t+1} = \theta_t + \eta d_t$	$g_{t+1} = g_t + \eta h_t$

Same principle

Move along a direction that decreases the objective.

Essential difference

In boosting, the correction itself is a learned function.

Operator Learning

Now, we learn all conditional expectations at once.

From One Conditional Expectation to All of Them

ORDINARY REGRESSION

Fix one input function

$$f(y) = y$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$\mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x]$$

learns one conditional query

OPERATOR LEARNING

Allow every admissible f

$$f \in L^2(P_Y)$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$\mathbb{E}[f(Y) \mid X = x]$$

learns a reusable map

$\mathcal{E} : L^2(P_Y) \to L^2(P_X)$ **maps f to the function** $x \mapsto \mathbb{E}[f(Y) \mid X = x]$.

A Compact Operator Has a Matrix-Like SVD

MATRIX

$$A = \sum_j \sigma_j u_j v_j^\top$$

orthonormal singular vectors u_j, v_j
rank-one matrices $u_j v_j^\top$

$\leftrightarrow$

OPERATOR

$$\mathcal{E} = \sum_j \sigma_j \phi_j \otimes \psi_j$$

orthonormal singular functions ϕ_j, ψ_j
rank-one operators $\phi_j \otimes \psi_j$

$\{\phi_j\} \subset L^2(P_X)$ and $\{\psi_j\} \subset L^2(P_Y)$ are orthonormal.

As in matrix SVD, orthonormality separates the spectral directions.

The Density Ratio Determines the Operator

DEPENDENCE KERNEL

$$\kappa(x,y) = \frac{p_{X,Y}(x,y)}{p_X(x)p_Y(y)}$$

compares the joint law with independence

$\Longrightarrow$

SUBSTITUTE THE CONDITIONAL DENSITY

$$\begin{aligned}(\mathcal{E}f)(x) &= \int f(y)p_{Y|X}(y \mid x)\,dy \\ &= \int f(y)\frac{p_{X,Y}(x,y)}{p_X(x)p_Y(y)}p_Y(y)\,dy \\ &= \int f(y)\kappa(x,y)\,dP_Y(y).\end{aligned}$$

$p_{Y|X}(y \mid x) = \kappa(x,y)p_Y(y) \quad \Longrightarrow \quad$ learning κ is enough to learn $\mathcal{E}$.

Comparing the Two Forms Identifies κ

USING THE SVD

$$(\mathcal{E}f)(x) = \sum_{j\geq 0} \sigma_j \langle f, \psi_j \rangle \phi_j(x) = \int f(y) \left[\sum_{j\geq 0} \sigma_j \phi_j(x) \psi_j(y) \right] dP_Y(y).$$

USING THE KERNEL

$$(\mathcal{E}f)(x) = \int f(y) \kappa(x, y)\, dP_Y(y).$$

Since both expressions are equal for every f, the terms multiplying $f(y)$ must be equal:

$$\boxed{\kappa(x, y) = \sum_{j\geq 0} \sigma_j \phi_j(x) \psi_j(y).}$$

Choose f to Choose the Question

CONDITIONAL MEAN

$$f(y) = y$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$(\mathcal{E}f)(x) = \mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x]$$

ordinary regression

CONDITIONAL CDF

$$f_t(y) = 1\{y \le t\}$$

$$\Downarrow$$

$$(\mathcal{E}f_t)(x) = \mathbb{P}(Y \le t \mid X = x)$$

uncertainty quantification

The operator stays fixed; only the input function changes.

The Operator Also Reveals Uncertainty and Dependence

CONDITIONAL VARIANCE

Use $f(y) = y$ and $f(y) = y^2$:

$$\mathrm{Var}(Y \mid X = x) = \mathbb{E}[Y^2 \mid X = x] - \mathbb{E}[Y \mid X = x]^2.$$

One operator supplies both moments.

INDEPENDENCE

$$X \perp Y \iff \kappa(x, y) = 1$$

no nonconstant singular components

The learned spectrum summarizes dependence beyond a single regression target.

How to Learn κ?

We now turn the operator into a learnable low-rank model.

A Low-Rank Model Makes κ Learnable

KNOWN BASELINE

$$1$$

independence component
$\sigma_0 = 1$

$+$

LEARNED LOW-RANK CORRECTION

$$\sum_{j=1}^{k} \sigma_j \phi_j^\star(x) \psi_j^\star(y)$$

keep only k nonconstant components

Absorb $\sqrt{\sigma_j}$ and stack the functions into two feature vectors:

$$\phi(x) = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\sigma_1}\phi_1^\star(x) \\ \vdots \\ \sqrt{\sigma_k}\phi_k^\star(x) \end{pmatrix}, \qquad \psi(y) = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\sigma_1}\psi_1^\star(y) \\ \vdots \\ \sqrt{\sigma_k}\psi_k^\star(y) \end{pmatrix}.$$

The model to learn is simply $\kappa_{\phi,\psi}(x, y) = 1 + \phi(x)^\top \psi(y)$.

Learn the Features by Matching the True Kernel

UNKNOWN TARGET

$$\kappa(x, y)$$

true density ratio

compare

LOW-RANK MODEL

$$\kappa_{\phi,\psi}(x, y) = 1 + \phi(x)^\top \psi(y)$$

feature maps to learn

Measure their squared L^2 distance:

$$\mathcal{L}(\phi, \psi) = \|\kappa - \kappa_{\phi,\psi}\|^2_{L^2(P_X \otimes P_Y)}$$

Choose ϕ and ψ so the low-rank kernel is as close as possible to κ.

Expanding the Loss Reveals Three Terms

$$\mathcal{L}(\phi, \psi) = \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[\kappa^2]}_{\text{constant}} - 2\underbrace{\mathbb{E}[\kappa\, \kappa_{\phi,\psi}]}_{\text{cross term}} + \underbrace{\mathbb{E}[\kappa^2_{\phi,\psi}]}_{\text{model term}} .$$

CONSTANT

Does not depend on ϕ, ψ.

Drop it.

CROSS TERM

Contains unknown κ.

Rewrite it.

MODEL TERM

Depends only on our model.

Estimate it.

Only the cross term looks problematic—and the density-ratio identity fixes it.

The Density-Ratio Identity Removes the Unknown κ

WHY THE IDENTITY HOLDS

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbb{E}_{P_X \otimes P_Y}[\kappa(X,Y)q(X,Y)] &= \int q(x,y)\,\kappa(x,y)p_X(x)p_Y(y)\,dx\,dy \\ &= \int q(x,y)\,p_{X,Y}(x,y)\,dx\,dy \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{P_{X,Y}}[q(X,Y)].\end{aligned}$$

Choose $q = \kappa_{\phi,\psi}$. Then the objective becomes

$$\boxed{L(\phi,\psi) = \mathbb{E}_{P_X \otimes P_Y}[\kappa^2_{\phi,\psi}] - 2\mathbb{E}_{P_{X,Y}}[\kappa_{\phi,\psi}]}$$

Product expectation

Estimate with independently paired X and Y.

Joint expectation

Estimate with the observed pairs (X_i, Y_i).

Functional Gradient Descent: Update ϕ with ψ Fixed

THE SAME UPDATE USED IN BOOSTING

$$\phi^{(t+1)} = \phi^{(t)} - \eta_\phi \nabla_\phi L(\phi^{(t)}, \psi)$$

FUNCTIONAL GRADIENT

$$\nabla_\phi L(x) = 2\Sigma_\psi \phi(x) - 2m_\psi(x)$$

a function of x

TERMS IN THE GRADIENT

$$\Sigma_\psi = \mathbb{E}[\psi(Y)\psi(Y)^\top]$$
$$m_\psi(x) = \mathbb{E}[\psi(Y) - \mathbb{E}\psi(Y) \mid X = x]$$

The update for ψ is identical after exchanging X and Y.

From Functional Gradient Boosting to a Newton Step

FIRST-ORDER FUNCTIONAL BOOSTING

Use only the functional gradient:

$$\phi^{(t+1)} = \phi^{(t)} - \eta_\phi \nabla_\phi L.$$

The gradient gives the direction.

SECOND-ORDER / NEWTON BOOSTING

Also use the functional Hessian:

$$\phi^{(t+1)} = \phi^{(t)} - \eta_\phi [\nabla^2_{\phi\phi} L]^{-1} \nabla_\phi L$$

The Hessian rescales the direction.

WHY THIS IS SIMPLE HERE

With ψ fixed, the loss is quadratic in ϕ and $\nabla^2_{\phi\phi} L = 2\Sigma_\psi$. The same holds after exchanging ϕ and ψ.

Alternate the Two Functional Newton Updates

1. FIX $\phi^{(t)}$, UPDATE ψ

Fix $\phi^{(t)}$.

Take one relaxed Newton step:

$$\psi^{(t+1)} = (1 - \eta_\psi)\psi^{(t)} + \eta_\psi \Sigma_{\phi,t}^{-1} m_{\phi,t}.$$

2. FIX $\psi^{(t+1)}$, UPDATE ϕ

Fix the new $\psi^{(t+1)}$.

Take the symmetric Newton step:

$$\phi^{(t+1)} = (1 - \eta_\phi)\phi^{(t)} + \eta_\phi \Sigma_{\psi,t+1}^{-1} m_{\psi,t+1}.$$

We update one block at a time; the next slide shows how the unknown terms are estimated.

Population Quantities Become Familiar Data Operations

EXPECTATIONS → AVERAGES

$$\mathbb{E}[\psi(Y)] \quad \longrightarrow \quad \overline{\psi} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_i \psi(Y_i)$$

$$\Sigma_\psi \quad \longrightarrow \quad \widehat{\Sigma}_\psi = \frac{1}{n}\sum_i \psi(Y_i)\psi(Y_i)^\top$$

CONDITIONAL EXPECTATIONS → REGRESSIONS

Recall the population target:

$$m_\psi(x) = \mathbb{E}[\psi(Y) - \mathbb{E}\psi(Y) \mid X = x].$$

Estimate it with the derived training pairs

$$\big(X_i,\ \psi(Y_i) - \overline{\psi}\big).$$

Reverse X and Y to estimate $m_\phi(y)$.

Flexible regressors such as decision trees can be used in both steps.

Every abstract population object has a direct empirical counterpart.

Spectral Balancing Makes the Factors Interpretable

BEFORE BALANCING

$$\widehat{\kappa} = 1 + \phi^\top \psi$$

Components are not necessarily orthogonal or normalized.



change coordinates

AFTER BALANCING

$$\widehat{\kappa} = 1 + \sum_{j=1}^{k} \widehat{\sigma}_j \widehat{\phi}_j^\star \widehat{\psi}_j^\star$$

Orthonormal singular functions and explicit singular values.

WHAT STAYS UNCHANGED

$$\widetilde{\phi} = A\phi, \quad \widetilde{\psi} = A^{-\top}\psi \quad \Longrightarrow \quad \widetilde{\phi}^\top \widetilde{\psi} = \phi^\top \psi.$$

Balancing changes the coordinates, not the estimated kernel.

Applications

Finally, let us see what the learned operator can do.

Application 1: Can Our Method Recover a Known Spectrum?

1. CHOOSE A BASIS

$X, Y \sim \mathrm{Unif}[-1, 1]$

$$e_1(t) = \sqrt{2}\cos(\pi t)$$
$$e_2(t) = \sqrt{2}\sin(\pi t)$$
$$e_3(t) = \sqrt{2}\cos(2\pi t)$$

The functions are orthonormal.

2. BUILD κ

$$\kappa(x, y) = 1 + \sum_{j=1}^{3} \sigma_j e_j(x) e_j(y)$$

with

$$\sigma = (0.30, 0.18, 0.10).$$

The exact spectrum is known.

3. FIT OUR METHOD

Sample from the resulting joint distribution and fit a rank-3 model.

Then compare the learned spectrum with the three known values.

Because the basis is orthonormal, the formula for κ is already its exact SVD.

Application 1: Our Method Recovers the Known Spectrum

20,000 training points · 5,000 validation points · rank $k = 3$

	σ_1	σ_2	σ_3
Exact	0.300	0.180	0.100
Our method $\widehat{\sigma}_j$	0.299	0.183	0.104

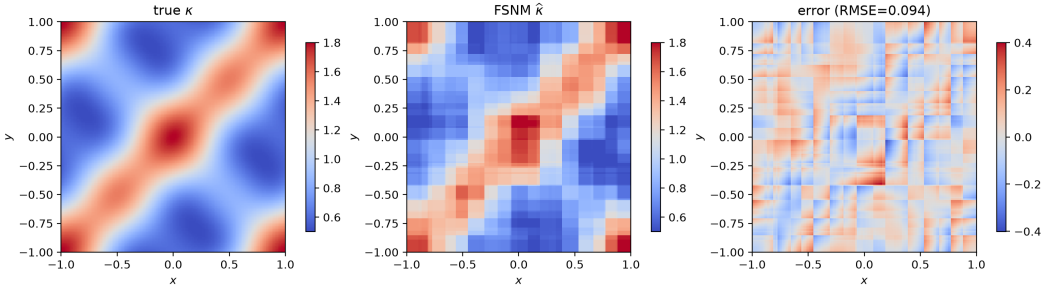
SPECTRUM

All three estimated singular values are close to the truth.

ORTHONORMALITY

$\|\widehat{\Sigma}_{\widehat{\phi}} - I\| \approx 10^{-15}$ after balancing.

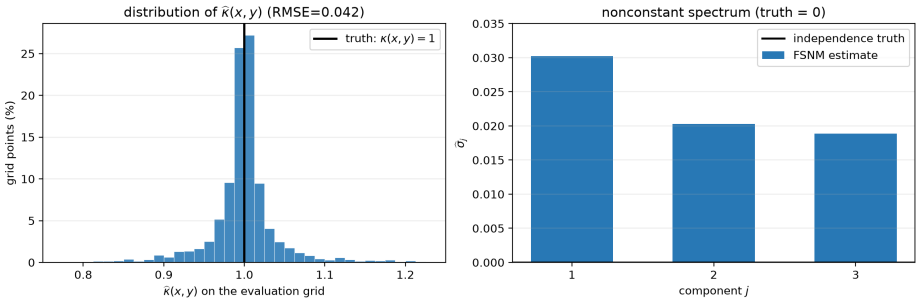
Application 1: The Main Structure Is Recovered



The blocky pattern comes from the decision trees used in the functional updates.

Application 2: Independence Leaves No Nonconstant Spectrum

If $X \perp Y$, then $p_{X,Y} = p_X p_Y$ and therefore $\kappa(x, y) = 1$. Hence $\kappa - 1 = 0$: every nonconstant singular value is zero. We simulate 20,000 independent pairs with $X, Y \sim \mathrm{Unif}[-1, 1]$ and still fit our method with rank $k = 3$.



Our method recovers $(\widehat{\sigma}_1, \widehat{\sigma}_2, \widehat{\sigma}_3) = (0.030, 0.020, 0.019)$; the small residual components are finite-sample estimation noise.

Under independence, our method finds only small finite-sample components.

Application 3: Fit Once, Answer Many Queries

FIXED

learned operator

$\widehat{\sigma}_j, \widehat{\phi}_j, \widehat{\psi}_j$

$+$

NEW QUERY

input function f

compute k projection coefficients

$=$

ANSWER

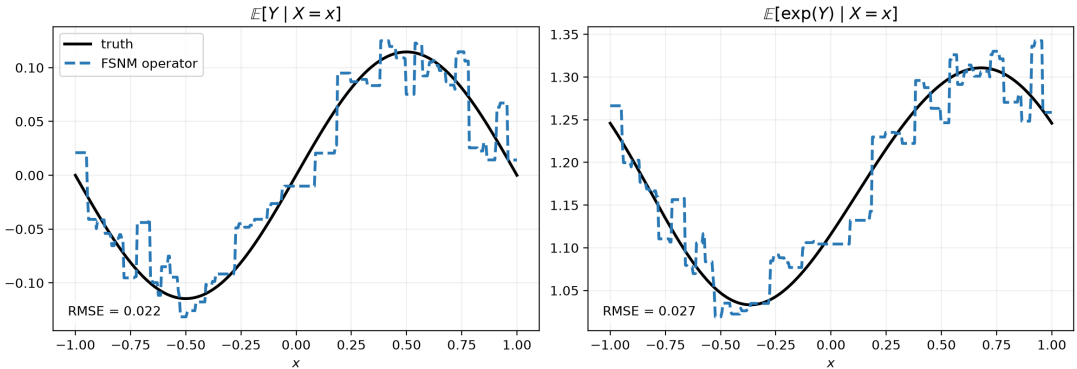
$(\widehat{\mathcal{E}} f)(x)$

no tree is refitted

$$(\widehat{\mathcal{E}} f)(x) = \overline{f} + \sum_{j=1}^{k} \widehat{\sigma}_j \widehat{\phi}_j(x) \underbrace{\left[\frac{1}{m} \sum_{\ell=1}^{m} f(Y_\ell) \widehat{\psi}_j(Y_\ell) \right]}_{\text{only this coefficient changes}}.$$

We will test $f(y) = y$ and $f(y) = e^y$ using the same fitted operator.

Application 3: The Same Fit Answers Both Queries



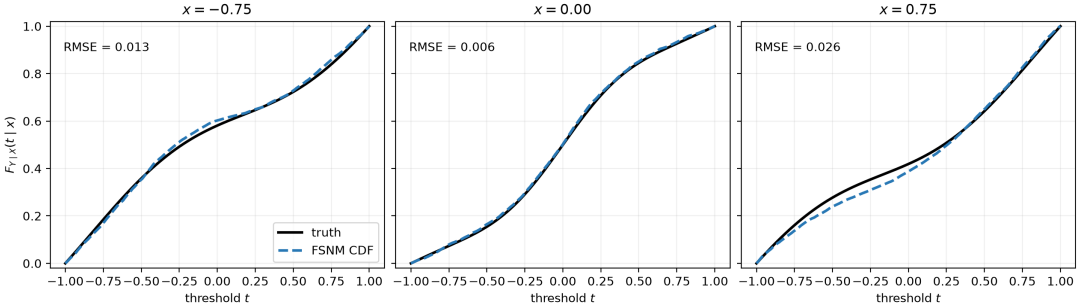
The same fitted operator answers both queries, with grid RMSEs 0.022 and 0.027, respectively.

Application 3: The Same Fit Recovers a Conditional CDF

For each threshold t, take $f_t(y) = 1\{y \le t\}$. Then

$$F_{Y|X}(t \mid x) = \mathbb{P}(Y \le t \mid X = x) = (\mathcal{E} f_t)(x).$$

Evaluating the same learned operator over a grid of t therefore estimates the entire conditional distribution, without refitting the model.



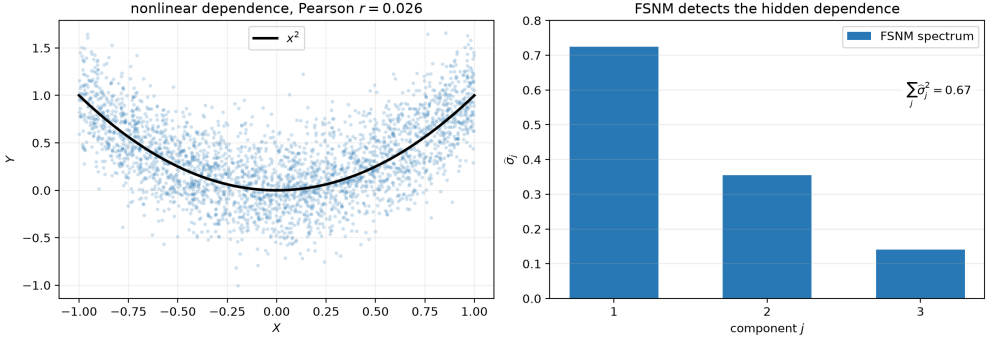
For $x \in \{-0.75, 0, 0.75\}$, the CDF RMSE ranges from 0.006 to 0.026; the estimated curves are already monotone in this run.

Application 4: Zero Correlation Does Not Mean Independence

Let

$$X \sim \mathrm{Unif}[-1,1], \qquad Y = X^2 + \varepsilon, \qquad \varepsilon \sim N(0, 0.3^2).$$

Symmetry gives $\mathrm{Cov}(X,Y) = \mathbb{E}[X^3] = 0$, although $\mathbb{E}[Y \mid X] = X^2$: zero linear correlation does not imply independence.



Pearson gives $r = 0.026$, while our method finds $\widehat{\sigma} = (0.725, 0.354, 0.141)$ and captured spectral energy $\sum_{j=1}^{3} \widehat{\sigma}_j^2 = 0.671$.

Summary

1. OPERATOR VIEW

Learn the map

$$f \longmapsto \mathbb{E}[f(Y) \mid X = \cdot]$$

instead of one regression target.

2. LOW-RANK MODEL

Represent the density ratio as

$$\kappa(x, y) \approx 1 + \phi(x)^\top \psi(y).$$

3. FUNCTIONAL NEWTON

Learn ϕ and ψ with alternating Newton steps built from ordinary regressions.

Fit the operator once, then reuse it for many conditional queries.

Thank you!

Questions?



Scan to read the paper

https://arxiv.org/abs/2609.35598